ELDERS QUORUM & RELIEF SOCIETY · 25 MIN

A Higher and Holier Fast

Elder Ulisses Soares · October 2026 general conference

ONE CORE TRUTH

Fasting with intentional prayer is worship that draws heaven near.

0:00–2:00

Welcome & prayer · Presidency

- A simple welcome, then invite someone to give the opening prayer.
- Keep business to what can't wait; no separate counseling topic. Then start right away.

2:00–5:00

Open · Teacher

- Ask: Is my fast a skipped meal or an act of worship with a clear purpose?
- Invite someone to read: “A sincere and faithful fast is accompanied by earnest and intentional prayer.”
- Give a quiet moment to ponder before anyone answers.

5:00–20:00

Discuss one core truth · Everyone

- Q1. Read Isaiah 58:6 together. How does it help us understand this truth about following Jesus Christ?
- Q2. When have you seen this truth at work in your own life or family?
- Optional, about 3 min: Turn to someone nearby and share your answer to Q2, then invite two or three people to share with everyone.
- Q3. What challenges or opportunities in our ward does this speak to? How could we help one another, including through our ministering and in our homes?
- Let members answer one another. Resist answering every question yourself.

20:00–24:00

Invite, testify, follow up · Teacher

- From the talk: Ponder Isaiah's teachings and embrace the law of the fast more intentionally as worship.
- Ask: “What do you feel impressed to do?” Give a minute to write it down privately.
- Bear brief testimony of Jesus Christ and this truth, or invite someone to.
- Next week, open by inviting one or two people to share how it went.

24:00–25:00

Closing prayer · Presidency

- Invite someone to give the closing prayer. End on time.

Timing follows the Church's 25-minute meeting guidance; adapt it as the Spirit directs. Read the full talk at ChurchofJesusChrist.org.